

CONSULTATION READINESS

Consultation Preparation Workbook

Organize the context, questions, records, and priorities that can make your consultation more productive.

A useful consultation usually starts with the responsibility or decision, not with a pile of documents. Use this workbook to clarify what is happening, what is blocked, and what outcome would actually help.

What brings you here?

What are you trying to accomplish?

What problem are you trying to resolve?

What decision feels blocked?

If nothing changes, what happens next?

What would a useful outcome look like?

Important timing

Timing item	Date	Why it matters	Confirmed?
Deadline / filing date		Timing can affect filing windows, renewal periods, response deadlines, or required action.	
Appointment / renewal		The date can affect eligibility, scheduling, or whether a decision is still workable.	
Launch / notice received		A date may change the urgency, the required response, or the next step.	
Other time-sensitive event		Some issues become harder to resolve when key deadlines pass or records expire.	

Why this matters

The most useful consultation often begins with timing and urgency. A short timeline can reveal the real pressure, what has already happened, and what needs to happen next.

Build the context

Who or what is already involved?

Examples: accountant, insurer, agency, lender, vendor, software platform, employer, client, family member, attorney, or internal team member.

Person, agency, provider, vendor, or system	Role in the situation	Contact / owner	Follow-up

What has already happened?

What worked well?

What did not work well?

What are you waiting on?

What has already been tried?

What feels unclear?

Use this to separate confusion from decision-making. A person may need clarification, an organized record set, a decision, or a referral.

Topic	Need clarification	Need organization	Need a decision	Need a referral
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Understanding the gap

Need clarification means the information exists but is not understood. Need organization means the facts are spread out or missing. Need a decision means more than information is needed. Need a referral means another qualified professional may be required.

Records to consider

Bring the records that explain the fact, the question, the deadline, or the decision. You do not need every file in your life.

Bring the record that explains the fact

Examples: notice, policy, agreement, prior return, registration, invoice, current workflow, correspondence, statement, account summary.

- ☐ Tax records or notices relevant to the issue
- ☐ Insurance summaries or current policy information
- ☐ Complete, unsigned document packet and requesting-party instructions
- ☐ Correspondence that explains what changed or what was requested

Bring the record that explains the question

Examples: conflicting instructions, missing information, deadline, prior recommendation, current requirement, or approval condition.

- ☐ Documents tied to the decision you are trying to make
- ☐ A current workflow, process, or system summary
- ☐ Records showing what has already happened
- ☐ Records showing what is still missing or unresolved

Records I may need

Record	Why it matters	Available?	Secure handling needed?

Security reminder

Do not send Social Security numbers, banking information, tax returns, identification documents, medical information, or other sensitive records through an unsecured contact form or ordinary email. Use only an approved secure method when instructed.

Consultation plan

Questions I want answered

Questions and points to clarify

My top three priorities

1.

2.

3.

During the consultation

Clarify

☐
☐
☐

Confirm the primary objective

Identify what is already known versus what is missing

Confirm the decision, deadline, or problem being addressed

Decide

☐
☐
☐

Identify the real next action

Confirm responsibilities and who owns follow-up

Confirm whether more records, a review, or a referral is needed

Close

☐
☐
☐

Establish next steps and timing

Confirm who owns each action

Identify follow-up date or review point

Before you leave the conversation

You should leave with a clear understanding of the next step, who owns it, what still needs to be done, and when follow-up should happen.

After the consultation

Action	Owner	Due date	Status

Next step

Need help working through this? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

This workbook provides general organizational guidance. It does not replace legal, tax, financial, insurance, or other qualified professional advice.